



SHRI. SHANKERSINH VAGHELA
Hon'ble Minister of Textiles

WEAVING GOLDEN DREAMS

A Unique Health Insurance Scheme was launched in 2005-06 specifically for handloom weavers which now covers over 50 lakhs handloom weavers

and family members, making it possibly the largest comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme in the country. Under this Scheme not only the weavers but his wife and two children are also covered and all pre-existing diseases are covered. Also the OPD component is Rs.7500/- out of the total annual limit of Rs.15,000/-. So far claims worth Rs. 109.67 crores have been settled. This is indeed a unique achievement as over 80% of the claims relate to the far flung rural areas of the country.

The Handloom Sector is the second largest employment generator in India after agriculture, giving employment to 65 lakhs weavers and allied workers. It represents the unique heritage of the country besides highlighting the exquisite skills which our weavers possess.

India has one of the richest histories of textile production spanning almost 5000 years. Indian fabrics were renowned for their sheer weaves and elaborate patterns. The process of dyeing, printing and painting patterns have always been highly advanced. This remarkable tradition of vibrant handwoven and handcrafted textiles has been handed down by skilled weavers and artisans from generation to generation.

Indian handwoven and handcrafted textiles are amongst our proudest and most enduring civilization inheritance. The outstanding tradition of vibrant embellishments on handwoven fabrics has been kept alive by skilled weavers and artisans from generation to generation. No doubt, handweaving techniques and intricate handcrafted designs reflect weavers' and artisans' outstanding skill and artistry. Innovative weavers and artisans, with their skillful blending of weaves and artistic use of different colours, myths, symbols, imagery in using embellishments on handloom fabrics, provide their fabrics an appealing dynamism which also reflects their emotional attachment to the fabric. The Ministry of Textiles through the Office of Development Commissioner (Handlooms) has taken various initiatives to develop the handloom sector

368 handloom clusters are being developed under the Integrated Handloom Development Scheme (IHDS) which provides funds for holistic and comprehensive development. Under this scheme, financial assistance is given to engage professional designers as also financial support for Common Facility Centres, Dye Houses, skill upgradation and support for exhibitions and Buyer Seller Meets. This is helping the weaving community in producing fabrics as per market demand.

Handloom Mark was launched by Hon'ble Prime Minister in June, 2006. This has been introduced to create a brand for handloom products. So far 4613 units have been registered under the Handloom Mark Scheme and 102.92 lakh Handloom Mark labels have been sold to them. 689 retail outlets are selling handloom fabrics with handloom labels all over the country.

Yarn at Subsidized Rates is being supplied under the Mill Gate Price Scheme (MGPS), wherein the cost of